



ACCELERATED EXPERIENCES, LLC

Municipal Branding Services

City of Lemoore, California · Request for Proposals, August 2026

SUBMITTED TO

Marisa Avalos, City Clerk · City of Lemoore · 711 W. Cinnamon Dr., Lemoore, CA 93245 · three printed copies and one electronic copy, as required

SCOPE

Brand research, qualitative and quantitative · focus groups and community meetings · three seals, three logos, three missions, three visions, three taglines · the chosen seal (embroiderable), logo and palette with a style manual

FEE

\$24,000 fixed, travel and expenses inside, itemized by phase in Section E · per-session fees for meetings beyond those included, in person and remote · no license fees

DUE

Thursday, October 1, 2026 · 2:00 PM Pacific · this proposal is valid for ninety days

ADDENDUM

Addendum No. 1, September 10, 2026 · acknowledged, signed and attached after Section G · the schedule, cost and research plan are written to it

PREPARED BY

Anthony Esposito · Digital & Creative Engineer/Founder · Accelerated Experiences, LLC · Post Falls, Idaho

CONTACT

208-618-1989 · ae@aexperiences.studio · aexperiences.com

Sections A to G in the RFP's order, then the signed Addendum No. 1. Then the sample work (two pages), the detailed specification, and the resume.

Three printed copies and one electronic copy, as Section 6 of the RFP requires.

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A • COVER LETTER

Ms. Avalos, and the selection panel,

RFP REQUIREMENT A — COVER LETTER

Firm name, contact information, statement of interest, authorized signature.

Accelerated Experiences, LLC is submitting for the City of Lemoore's municipal identity: a seal the City has never had, a logo, a mission, a vision, a tagline and a palette, delivered with a style manual. I am the contact and the person who will do the work: Anthony Esposito, Digital & Creative Engineer/Founder, 208-618-1989, ae@aexperiences.studio.

Your RFP asks for two things most branding proposals treat as one. The first is research — a brand research plan, qualitative and quantitative, and community focus groups, so that the three seals and three logos put in front of Council come from Lemoore rather than from a designer's taste. The second is the identity itself, built to be used: an embroiderable seal, a palette that carries your deep red, dark blue, tan and white, and a manual a new hire can follow. Research is my trade. For twenty-one years I ran household-level segmentation for nine media titles in Northern California — I know how to find out what a city thinks of itself and put it in front of a room of officials so the room agrees. Identity is the other half of the record: a health system's giving mark and a Napa practice's look from 2005, a hospice mark from 2011, a private club in Santa Rosa, and my own mark from 2011 are all still in use, under owners who could have replaced them. The sample sheet shows them beside a two-line family of fifty product marks built this year.

Two things said plainly. This would be my first city seal; the marks above were made for businesses and a club. And the identity will be drawn after the research, not before — the RFP is right to ask for it in that order, and nothing in this proposal pretends to know what Lemoore's seal should look like yet. What I can promise is the process, the count, the schedule and the price, and that the owner of this firm and the person doing the work are the same person. If the panel holds interviews the weeks of October 19 and 26, I would welcome the room.

Addendum No. 1, dated September 10, 2026, is acknowledged, signed and attached after Section G, and this proposal is written to it: completion inside the first quarter of 2027, a fee that already carries travel and expenses, meeting fees stated per session, and every public-facing material in English and Spanish. This proposal is valid for ninety days from October 1, 2026.



Anthony Esposito — Digital & Creative Engineer/Founder, Accelerated Experiences, LLC

2864 N Ivy Ln, Post Falls, Idaho 83854 • 208-618-1989 • ae@aexperiences.studio • aexperiences.com

B • QUALIFICATIONS AND EXPERIENCE

Research first, then the mark

RFP REQUIREMENT B — QUALIFICATIONS AND EXPERIENCE

Firm history. Relevant experience. Similar projects. Sample work.

Firm history. Accelerated Experiences began in 2011 as an assumed business name in Idaho and became an Idaho limited liability company in May 2026. The mark drawn in 2011 is still the mark. The firm builds operating systems for small businesses and identities for the people who run them; fourteen business systems and thirty-odd personal products are open at aexperiences.com, each with its own mark inside one family — the sample sheet shows the whole architecture on two pages.

Relevant experience — the research half. Marketing Analyst for the New York Times Regional Media Group's North Bay titles (2003–2007) and Market Research Analyst for MediaNews Group's Bay Area papers (2008): Claritas PRIZM household segmentation, Scarborough audience data, surveys and focus groups, run at zip-code level across five counties, and presented to city and county officials and to newsroom leadership. The New York Times Chairman's Award, March 2006, for a five-pronged targeted campaign built from that research. I was a speaker at the Claritas annual summit, teaching the data company's own customers how to apply its product. That method — find out who lives here and what they believe about the place, then put it in front of the room as a story the room can act on — is the brand research plan in Section 3 of your RFP, and it is what Phase 1 delivers.

Relevant experience — the identity half. Sutter Health, 2005: a household-level donor campaign by direct mail for the not-for-profit's giving program, with one partner at PD Direct; the logo and scheme were tuned in the course of it as a paid turnkey project, and the mark still holds at sutterhealth.org/giving. Vineyard Dental Spa, Napa: the whole look, worked out in 2005 with the owners and my manager at PD Direct, still the practice's face. Auburn Crest Hospice, Coeur d'Alene: as Marketing Director in 2011 I made the blue butterfly mark and moved the company from a law-firm look to a human one; fifteen years and several locations later it is unchanged. The Fountaingrove Club, Santa Rosa, from the same North Bay years. Barry Burris, NMD, 2026: three concept directions, a chosen monogram and medallion, lockups, a brand sheet. And the fifty-one product marks of my own two lines, each named, drawn and placed inside a system this year.

Similar projects. No prior city seal — said once, here, so the panel need not look for it. What is similar is the shape of the work: research, then three directions, then revisions with the people who have to live with it, then a manual so the mark survives the person who drew it. Every mark on the sample sheet went through that shape.

Sample work. The two-page sheet that follows this proposal; every mark on it is live and checkable at the address printed under it.

B, CONTINUED • HOW THE WORK IS DONE

Five phases, in the RFP's own order

Phase 1 — Brand research (qualitative and quantitative). A short resident survey, online and on paper at City Hall, the library and the Recreation Center, in English and Spanish, with a household-level read of who answered against the Census so the sample is weighted to the city and not to whoever showed up. Three to four focus groups — long-time residents, Navy families connected to NAS Lemoore, business owners, and students and young families — plus interviews with Council members, department heads, the Chamber, and the Tachi-Yokut Tribe at the Santa Rosa Rancheria, whose place in Lemoore's story the community has already raised. Every survey, guide and handout is in English and Spanish; the City's staff translator, offered in Addendum No. 1, is welcome at every session, and the Spanish-language co-moderator stays in the fee. The entries from the City's seal design contest, offered in the addendum, are read before the survey is written, so residents are not asked twice what they have already answered. A scan of every seal and logo in Kings County and the neighboring cities so Lemoore's does not look like anyone else's. Output: a findings report in plain English with the five or six things Lemoore believes about itself, what "There is more in Lemoore" means to the people who say it, and a positioning recommendation.

Phase 2 — Identity directions. From the findings: three City seals, three City logos, three mission statements, three vision statements and three taglines — no fewer, as the RFP asks. Each seal drawn to embroider from the start (limited colors, no gradients, no hairlines), each logo shown at the sizes it will actually live at — a truck door, a letterhead, a website favicon, a police patch. Addendum No. 1 allows the three of each to be concept sketches; they will be shown at working sizes anyway, because a seal that only works as a sketch is not a seal. The mission, vision and tagline are written from scratch. The palette keeps the City's deep red, dark blue, tan and white as the primaries and adds a small, named secondary set for accents, as the addendum permits. Presented to City Management first, then to Council in a public session with the research beside it, so the choice is made on what residents said and not on the room's mood that night.

Phase 3 — Revisions. Council and staff revisions incorporated in two rounds, with a written record of each change and why, so a future Council can see how the seal came to be.

Phase 4 — The manual. The chosen seal, logo and palette delivered as a style manual: the fonts, the colors in every system a print shop, a sign shop, an embroiderer and a web developer will ask for, clear space, minimum sizes, what not to do, and the department lockups (Police, Fire, Public Works, Parks and Recreation, the Council) so the system extends without a designer.

Phase 5 — Rollout. Master files in every format; the seal as vector artwork drawn to embroidery constraints, which Addendum No. 1 confirms is sufficient — digitized stitch files and a stitched sample are not required, and if the City's embroiderer wants a DST or PES file, one is provided at no charge; vehicle, signage, letterhead, business card and digital templates, and a written cost estimate and timeline for replacing what the City has today in a sensible order — the RFP's last bullet.

What the City gets that it did not ask for

A written record of the research and the decisions, filed with the City, so that in fifteen years the seal still means what it meant the day Council chose it. Every mark on the sample sheet has outlived the contract that made it; that is the standard this one is drawn to.

C • PROJECT TEAM

Three people, one of whom draws

RFP REQUIREMENT C — PROJECT TEAM
Organization chart. Resumes. Qualifications.

PERSON	ROLE ON THIS PROJECT	BACKGROUND
Anthony Esposito — Digital & Creative Engineer/Founder	Every phase: the research design, the focus groups, the presentations to Management and Council, every seal, logo and line of the manual. The City's single point of contact.	Twenty-one years of market research and identity work; resume attached
Brian — Chief Operating Officer	Scheduling, the survey field plan, focus-group logistics, print and embroidery vendor coordination, acceptance sign-off at each phase	Accelerated Experiences, LLC
Roz — Head of Operations	Survey coding and tabulation, the findings report's tables, the written record of revisions, the manual's production	Accelerated Experiences, LLC
Spanish-language moderator	Co-moderates the Spanish-language focus group and reviews every Spanish-language material; works alongside the City's staff translator offered in Addendum No. 1	Named at kickoff; included in the fee

Organization. Anthony reports to the City's assigned Project Manager and presents to City Management and Council; Brian and Roz report to Anthony. There is no account executive, no junior designer and no subcontracted studio — the person who ran the focus group is the person who draws the seal, and the person who drew the seal is the person who presents it.

Resumes. Anthony's full curriculum vitae follows the sample sheet as an attachment.

Qualifications, stated plainly. Research: household-level segmentation for two media companies, a parent-company award for it, and a seat on a data vendor's own stage. Identity: five marks still in use fifteen to twenty-one years on. Not here: a completed city seal — the reason the research comes first.

D • REFERENCES

People who will take your call

RFP REQUIREMENT D — REFERENCES
Provide a minimum of three (3) professional references where similar Projects were completed.

REFERENCE	WHAT THEY SAW COMPLETED	CONTACT
Barry Burris, NMD — functional medicine and longevity practice	His identity system, 2026: three concept directions, the chosen monogram and medallion, lockups, brand sheet and social covers. He also runs his practice on an operating system this firm built.	208-661-3545 • barryburris@hotmail.com
Nathan Bremer — General Manager and Director of Supply Chain, Protein Puck	Brand and web work, and a market-research tool built for him that became a product family	(208) 699-5797 • Nate@puckpackaging.com
Brian Asmus — former Police Chief, City of Liberty Lake, Washington (nineteen years); Liberty Lake fire commissioner	Reviews the applications and public-facing work this firm ships, before it ships; a public official's read of the work	509-998-3732 • spsasmus@gmail.com

The marks on the sample sheet from 2005 and 2011 can be checked without a phone call: sutterhealth.org/giving, yournapadentist.com, auburncrest.com and thefountaingroveclub.com show them today.

Attachments. Sample work — the identity portfolio, two pages — follows this proposal; Anthony Esposito's curriculum vitae follows the sample sheet. The detailed specification (the research instrument, the embroidery and file standards for the seal, the manual's table of contents and the rollout kit's contents) follows the sample sheet, and is also provided as its own file on the electronic copy. A short film walking through the sample work and the process, sound on: <https://www.aexperiences.com/watch/lemoore.html>

Insurance and license. Insurance at the RFP's limits and a City of Lemoore business license will be in place before contract execution, as Sections 9 and 10 require. The firm will enter the Professional Services Agreement approved by the City Attorney.

E • COST PROPOSAL

\$24,000, fixed, travel inside — itemized by phase, with fees per session

RFP REQUIREMENT E — COST PROPOSAL

Provide full cost proposal with itemization. Clearly define what is included in the price. List any assumptions made in preparing costs proposal. Addendum No. 1: all proposals must include fees, travel and reimbursable expenses; specify per-meeting fees for in-person and remote sessions.

PHASE	HOURS	RATE	FEE
1 • Brand research — survey (English and Spanish, online and paper), weighting against the Census, three to four focus groups, stakeholder interviews, regional seal and logo scan, findings report and positioning recommendation	48	\$125	\$6,000
2 • Identity directions — three seals, three logos, three missions, three visions, three taglines, each shown at working sizes; presentations to City Management and to Council	56	\$125	\$7,000
3 • Revisions — two rounds with staff and Council, written record of every change	24	\$125	\$3,000
4 • Style manual — the chosen seal, logo and palette; fonts, color systems, clear space, minimum sizes, misuse, department lockups	40	\$125	\$5,000
5 • Rollout — master files in every format, embroidery-tested seal file, vehicle, signage, stationery and digital templates, replacement cost estimate and timeline	24	\$125	\$3,000
Total — fixed fee, travel and expenses inside	192		\$24,000

MEETINGS — WHAT THE FIXED FEE INCLUDES, AND THE FEE PER SESSION BEYOND IT	FEE
Included in the \$24,000: the kickoff with City Management; up to four focus groups; two community meetings; two presentations to Council in public session; the handover session with staff — held in three trips to Lemoore, with the travel inside the fee.	Included
Additional in-person session — a focus group, community meeting or Council presentation beyond those included, when it can be held on a trip already scheduled. Bilingual materials, facilitation, and the written summary included.	\$650 per session
Additional trip — when an in-person session cannot be placed on a scheduled trip. Air from Spokane to Fresno, a car, one night; no other expense is billed.	\$850 per trip
Remote session — by video, up to ninety minutes, with the same bilingual materials and written summary. No travel.	\$300 per session

What is included. Everything in Section 3 of the RFP: the meetings, the public involvement, the focus groups and community meetings, the research plan and its execution, the three-of-each directions, the revisions, the manual, the embroiderable seal, and the cost and timeline recommendations. As Addendum No. 1 requires, travel and every reimbursable expense are inside the fixed fee: three trips to Lemoore, the printing of the bilingual survey forms, and the bilingual materials for every session. Nothing is billed separately. The fonts recommended will be open-license so the City never pays a type fee. The City owns every file and every right on delivery.

Assumptions. The City provides meeting rooms for the focus groups and community meetings, posts the survey on its own channels, provides the stakeholder contact lists and the seal design contest entries, and makes a Project Manager available for a weekly thirty-minute check-in — each of these offered in Addendum No. 1. Additional rounds of revision beyond the two included, or additional directions beyond three of each, at \$125 per hour on the City's written authorization. Payment by phase on acceptance: 25% at kickoff, 25% on the findings report, 25% on Council's selection, 25% on delivery of the manual and rollout files.

F • TIMELINE

From selection to a seal on the dais — inside the first quarter of 2027

RFP REQUIREMENT F — TIMELINE

Provide full, detailed timeline from selection to Project completion. Addendum No. 1: completion desired within the first quarter of 2027; City Council meets the first and third Tuesday of each month at 5:30 p.m.

WHEN	WHAT	MILESTONE
Nov 17 – Nov 24, 2026	Council approval (Nov 17, per the RFP). Agreement, business license, insurance certificates. Kickoff with City Management on Nov 24: vision, calendar, the department list for lockups, the contest entries and the stakeholder lists handed over.	Kickoff, Nov 24
Nov 30, 2026 – Jan 8, 2027	Phase 1. The bilingual survey open Dec 1 to Dec 31, online and on paper across the holidays; the contest entries and the regional seal scan read in December; focus groups, community meeting and stakeholder interviews on one trip, Jan 5 to Jan 8.	Findings report, Jan 12
Jan 11 – Feb 16, 2027	Phase 2. Three of each drawn from the findings; reviewed with City Management the week of Feb 1; presented to Council in public session at the regular meeting of Tuesday, Feb 16, 5:30 p.m.	Council selection, Feb 16
Feb 17 – Mar 16, 2027	Phase 3. Two rounds of revisions with staff and Council, each on the written record; the chosen direction adopted at the regular meeting of Tuesday, Mar 16.	Direction locked, Mar 16
Mar 1 – Mar 26, 2027	Phase 4. The style manual, begun as the direction narrows and finished after adoption; the vector seal proved against embroidery constraints; department lockups.	Manual delivered, Mar 26
Mar 22 – Mar 31, 2027	Phase 5. Master files, production-ready templates, the replacement cost estimate and timeline; handover session with staff on Mar 30.	Complete, Mar 31, 2027

Nineteen weeks from Council approval, finishing inside the first quarter of 2027 as Addendum No. 1 asks. Both Council presentations fall on regular meetings, the first and third Tuesday at 5:30 p.m. If approval comes later than November 17, the schedule slides day for day and the March 31 date moves with it — said here so no one is surprised by it later.

G • CONTRACT TERMINATION

None

RFP REQUIREMENT G — CONTRACT TERMINATION

If Firm has had a contract terminated in the last five (5) years, describe such incident. If the Firm has not experienced any such termination for default or early termination in the past five (5) years, so indicate.

Accelerated Experiences, LLC has had no contract terminated for default or terminated early in the past five years, and none in its history.

SAMPLE WORK • THE IDENTITY PORTFOLIO

Marks the next owner kept.

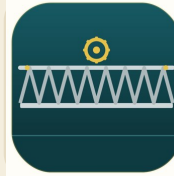
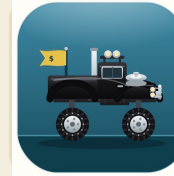
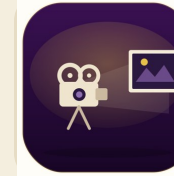
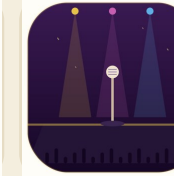
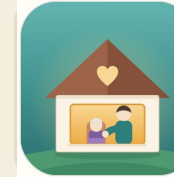
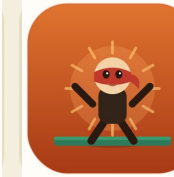
The RFP asks for sample work and similar projects. Everything here is live and checkable: a health system's giving mark and a Napa practice's look from 2005, a Santa Rosa club, a hospice mark and the firm's own mark from 2011, a two-line brand architecture of fifty-one products at aexperiences.com, and a physician's identity system delivered this summer. The test of a mark is whether the next owner keeps it.

Five marks, five owners, twenty-one years — none replaced

				
sutterhealth.org/giving , today	yournapadentist.com , today	auburncrest.com , today	thefountaingroveclub.com , today	aexperiences.com
Sutter Health — 2005	Vineyard Dental — 2005	Auburn Crest — 2011	Fountaingrove Club	The ae mark — 2011
A household-level donor campaign by direct mail for the not-for-profit's giving program, with Anthony and one partner at PD Direct; the logo and scheme were tuned in the course of it as a paid turnkey project. The mark still holds at sutterhealth.org/giving .	The whole look was thought out in 2005 by the owner and his wife with Anthony and his manager at PD Direct. Twenty-one years later it is the practice's face at yournapadentist.com .	The blue butterfly with the figure, arms raised: made by Anthony as Marketing Director, replacing a look that read like a law firm. Still the mark fifteen years and several locations later.	A member-owned private golf club. The cattail mark and the round seal are the club's face today at thefountaingroveclub.com — the work sits in the same 2005–2007 North Bay run.	Drawn in 2011 for Accelerated Experiences as an assumed business name; carried unchanged into the LLC. Fifteen years, one mark, now the masterbrand over every line below.

The business line — fourteen operating systems, one naming system, one shape

Each runs a different kind of company. The suffix, the tile and the illustration style make them one family at a glance — the same discipline a city needs across its departments, from the seal on the Council dais to the truck door.

						
Abode OS real-estate practice	Buttress OS architecture studio	Truss OS engineering firm	4barrel OS used-car dealer	8mm OS film production	Amphitheater OS live venue	Musical OS playhouse / theater
						
Moments OS photographer	Smiley OS dental practice	Sleeves OS tattoo studio	Toolbelt OS field service / trades	Stay@Home OS home care agency	LilNinja OS gyms, camps, kids	Targeted OS marketing agency

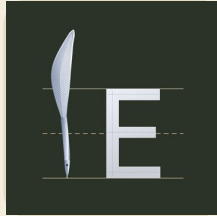
SAMPLE WORK • THE IDENTITY PORTFOLIO, CONTINUED

The personal line — the ESPO family and the household tools

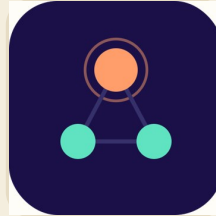
One prefix carries the family: ESPO for learning, music, film and play. Beside it, the household tools — Neuro Divulge, The Narcs, Xpense, Wire — each with its own mark inside the same system.



ESPO Music
five instruments, a real coach



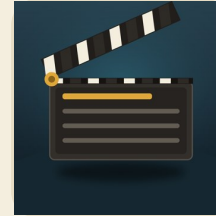
ESPO Learning
handwriting, reading, math, writing



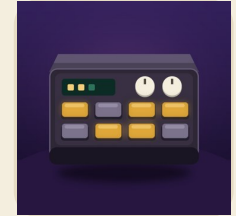
ESPO Genius
fine print in plain English



ESPO Drama
write, run lines, warm up



ESPO Cutlabs
video editing in the browser



ESPOfunkmaster
a studio in your browser



ESPOhystory
history told funny, read aloud



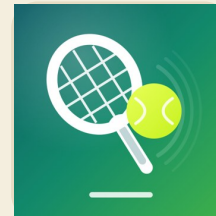
ESPOvocab
a word a day that sticks



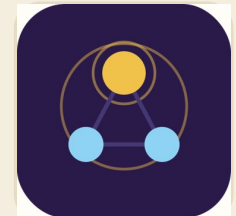
ESPOwords
word game with real friends



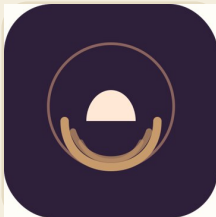
ESPOdraw
draw-and-guess, two to eight



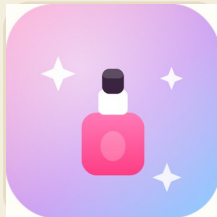
ESPORacket
tag your match film



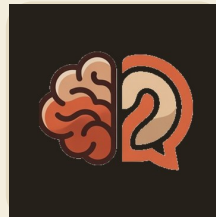
ESPOsign
sign forms in your browser



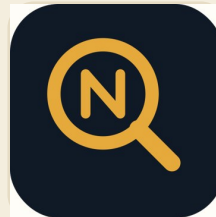
ESPOnest
sleep, feeds, diapers at 3 am



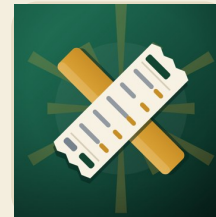
Sparkle Salon
run your own salon



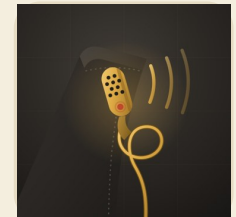
Neuro Divulge
regulation tools for ADHD, autism



The Narcs
fine print and tickers, read

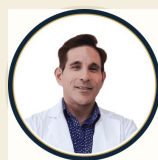


Xpense OS
say your expenses, Brian writes them



AE Wire
the meeting, recorded into notes

A client identity, delivered 2026 — Barry Burris, NMD (functional medicine and longevity)



Three concept directions, a chosen monogram, medallion, stacked and horizontal lockups, light and navy versions, a brand sheet and social covers — the same deliverable set the City is asking for, at a physician's scale. Dr. Burris also runs his practice on an AE operating system; the relationship is disclosed in the references.

Every product mark above is live at aexperiences.com. Nothing here is a mock-up.

DETAILED SPECIFICATION

What the City receives, to the file

This document sits behind the proposal. The proposal says what will be done and what it costs; this says exactly what each phase produces, in what form, and to what standard, so that the City can hold the work to it. Nothing here is extra to the fee. Section numbers follow the proposal's five phases.

PHASE	DELIVERABLE	FORM	STANDARD
1 • Research	Survey instrument, field plan, findings report, positioning recommendation, regional scan	PDF report; survey data as CSV; presentation deck	Sample weighted to Census; every claim in the report traceable to a table
2 • Directions	Three seals, three logos, three missions, three visions, three taglines; two presentations	Print boards and PDF; each mark at six working sizes; Council deck	Seals drawn to embroider from the first sketch
3 • Revisions	Two revision rounds; the written record of every change	PDF, dated	Each change tied to who asked and why
4 • Manual	The style manual	PDF (print and screen); source files	A new hire can produce a correct letterhead from it alone
5 • Rollout	Master files, production-ready templates, the vector seal proved against embroidery constraints, replacement estimate and timeline	Vector, raster and office formats, with embroidery files on request; a folder tree	Every file opens in the software the City already owns

1 • BRAND RESEARCH

The instrument, the field plan, the report

The survey. Fifteen to eighteen questions, eight minutes, in English and Spanish, built with the City's Project Manager and approved by City Management before it opens. Online (a City web address and QR code on every poster and utility-bill insert) and on paper at City Hall, the library, the Recreation Center and the Senior Center. Four weeks open. Question groups: how long you have lived here and what brought you; three words for Lemoore; what you are proud of and what you would change; what "There is more in Lemoore" means to you; which places stand for the city (open-ended, coded afterward); reactions to the four adopted colors; and demographics for weighting only — age band, household type, zip code, connection to NAS Lemoore, language at home.

Weighting and the read. Responses weighted to the American Community Survey for Lemoore by age, household type and language so the findings describe the city and not the people who happened to answer. A household-level segmentation overlay of the city's zip codes (the method Anthony ran for two media companies) so the report can say which kinds of households hold which view — long-time families, Navy households, young renters, retirees.

Focus groups and interviews. Three to four groups of eight to ten, ninety minutes, in City rooms: long-time residents; families connected to NAS Lemoore; business owners and the Chamber; students and young families (one group in Spanish, co-moderated). Discussion guide approved in advance. Individual interviews, thirty minutes: each Council member, the City Manager, department heads, and two or three people the City names as keepers of the town's history. Sessions recorded with consent for the record; no recording published.

The regional scan. Every seal and logo in Kings County and the surrounding cities (Hanford, Corcoran, Avenal, Coalinga, Visalia, Tulare, Fresno) and the County's own, on one sheet, so Lemoore's directions are drawn to be distinguishable from all of them at a distance.

The findings report. Twelve to twenty pages in plain English: what residents said, by group and in aggregate; the five or six beliefs Lemoore holds about itself; the words that recurred; what the tagline means to those who use it; the color findings; the regional scan; and a one-page positioning recommendation the identity will be drawn to. Presented to City Management and available to Council before any mark is shown.

2 • IDENTITY DIRECTIONS

Three of each, drawn to be used

Count. Three City seals, three City logos, three mission statements, three vision statements and three slogans/taglines — the RFP's minimum, met exactly, each direction internally consistent so the City can choose a whole rather than mix parts that were never meant to sit together. A fourth of any kind only if the findings demand it.

What each seal is drawn to. A seal is stitched, stamped, cast and engraved as well as printed, so every seal is drawn under embroidery constraints from the first sketch: no more than four thread colors plus the ground; no gradients, no tints, no strokes finer than the equivalent of one millimeter at a three-inch patch; lettering no smaller than the equivalent of six millimeters cap height at that size; a version that holds at one inch (a lapel pin), one at three inches (a patch or a podium), and one at three feet (the dais and the Council chamber wall). Each seal shown in full color, in one color, in reverse, and as a blind emboss.

What each logo is drawn to. The logo is the everyday mark — website, letterhead, truck door, social media. Each direction includes a primary lockup, a stacked version, an icon-only version for favicons and app tiles, and the relationship rules between seal and logo (when each is used, and when both). Shown at six working sizes: favicon, business card, letterhead, website header, vehicle door, monument sign.

Color. The adopted deep red, dark blue, tan and white carried into every direction, specified in Pantone, CMYK, RGB, hex and thread (Madeira and Isacord numbers) with contrast ratios stated for text on each ground.

Presentation. To City Management first (a working session, two hours, boards on the table); then to Council in public session, with the findings report beside the directions and each direction traced back to what residents said. The public sees the research before the marks, in that order.

3 • REVISIONS

Two rounds, one record

Round one after Council's selection: consolidated staff and Council comments, one revised direction returned within ten working days. Round two on that revision, returned within seven. Every change is logged — what changed, who asked, why, and what it cost or saved against the embroidery constraints — and the log is delivered with the manual so a future Council can read how the seal came to be. Changes beyond two rounds are quoted at the hourly rate before they are made.

4 • THE STYLE MANUAL

Table of contents

SECTION	CONTENTS
1 • The idea	One page: what the research found and what the identity says, so the manual explains itself to whoever opens it in ten years
2 • The seal	Full color, one color, reverse, emboss; minimum sizes; clear space; the embroidery specification; where the seal is used and where it is not (official documents, the chamber, uniforms, vehicles of record)
3 • The logo	Primary, stacked and icon lockups; minimum sizes; clear space; placement on light, dark and photographic grounds; the seal-and-logo relationship rules
4 • Color	The palette with Pantone, CMYK, RGB, hex and thread values; tints permitted; contrast table for text; the four adopted colors as the core and the supporting neutrals
5 • Typography	Primary and secondary typefaces (open-license, no fee to the City), sizes and weights for headings, body, captions and signage; the system-font fallback for everyday office documents
6 • Department lockups	Police, Fire, Public Works, Parks and Recreation, Community Development, Finance, the City Council and the City Clerk — each as a logo lockup and, where warranted, a seal variant
7 • Applications	Letterhead, envelope, business card, email signature, website header and favicon, social profiles and covers, vehicle door, uniform patch, monument and wayfinding signage, podium, Council chamber, presentation template
8 • Misuse	What not to do, shown: stretching, recoloring, drop shadows, low contrast, the seal on informal material, the logo on official documents
9 • Voice	The mission, vision and tagline as adopted; how they are used; three sentences of tone guidance for staff who write
10 • Files and contacts	The folder tree, file naming, who holds the masters, and how to ask for a new application

Delivered as a PDF for print and a PDF for screen, plus the source files. Forty to sixty pages. Written so that a new hire can produce a correct letterhead from the manual alone, without calling anyone.

5 • ROLLOUT KIT

Every file, every format, tested

ASSET	FORMATS DELIVERED
Seal — full color, one color, reverse, emboss	SVG, EPS, PDF (vector); PNG at 512, 1024, 2048 and 4096 px with transparency; JPG on white
Seal — embroidery	Vector artwork drawn to embroidery constraints, which Addendum No. 1 confirms is sufficient; DST and PES digitized files provided on request at no charge; no stitched sample is required or charged for
Logo — every lockup and color version	SVG, EPS, PDF; PNG at 256, 512, 1024, 2048 px; favicon set (ICO, 16 to 512 px); app icon set
Department lockups	The same set for each department
Stationery	Letterhead, envelope, business card and memo as editable Word and Google Docs templates and as print-ready PDFs
Digital	Email signature (HTML), PowerPoint and Google Slides template, social profile and cover images sized for each platform
Vehicle and signage	Door and tailgate layouts for the City's fleet types, monument and wayfinding sign faces, all as vector with dimensions for the sign shop
The replacement plan	A costed list, in a sensible order, of what to replace first (website, stationery, the chamber, uniforms, vehicles, signage) with estimated local vendor costs and a twelve-month timeline

Ownership. The City owns every file and every right on delivery; no license fees, no font fees, no retained rights. The masters are handed over in one folder tree with a one-page index, and a two-hour handover session with staff walks through where everything is and how to ask for a new application.

Acceptance

Each phase is accepted in writing by the City's Project Manager against this specification before the next invoice. If a deliverable does not meet the line it is held to here, it is corrected at no cost before acceptance.

Anthony Esposito

DIGITAL & CREATIVE ENGINEER/FOUNDER

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One method, twenty-one years. I have been building the systems that run businesses since **PD Direct** — the direct-marketing division Don Wolfe and I started inside the New York Times Regional Media Group — where I built the estimator, the production system, and the accounting and billing in FileMaker Pro. That is the same concept as everything catalogued below. Alongside it I turned household-level data into targeted, profitable marketing across five counties, and later ran operations in a regulated industry. Today that discipline runs at a different scale: **fourteen multi-tenant vertical SaaS operating systems, thirty-four consumer applications, and the agent runtime that operates them** — including a typed message bus, a validation layer that makes bluffed confidence arithmetically impossible, and a multi-agent organizational pattern documented in a working thesis. Everything listed here is live and enterable in a browser.

Layer 0 — Typed Message Bus PYTHON

Synchronous dispatch over a registry of named node handlers. Every message is typed on three axes — kind, direction and hop budget. Loop prevention is a TTL rather than a heuristic: the effective ceiling is `min(bus.max_hops, msg.max_hops)`, so a node may tighten its own budget but can never grant itself more runway. Hardened by adversarial review that found and closed three real defects, including a silent-loss path disguised as successful delivery.

The Output Contract HONESTY AS A SCHEMA

A frozen structure of stance, integer confidence 0–100, and two to three reasons, each tagged `data` or `assumption`. Conviction is derived, never claimed: if no reason is data-backed, the conclusion is forced to low-conviction regardless of the stated number. Oversize payloads are rejected rather than truncated, and a null payload raises *"silence is not allowed."*

Multi-Tenant White-Label Factory 14 VERTICALS LIVE

A tenant-agnostic engine in which one configuration file is the only swap point — brand, skin, vocabulary, rooms, roles and AI persona. Each tenant deploys as its own project with its own environment, so isolation happens at the platform boundary rather than through row-level filtering. Every API is environment-gated with graceful degradation, so a cold clone renders and demonstrates with zero credentials configured.

The Spine & Rooms Model DOMAIN MODELING

Each vertical is modeled around a single core domain object — a project, a listing, a show, a membership, a person — and every module page is a projection over that one record rather than a separate silo. Cross-room consistency becomes structural instead of synchronized, and adding a room stays additive and cheap.

Runtime Truth Enforcement AGENT RECEIPTS

A server-side guard that forces a real tool call and emits a receipt, so an agent cannot narrate work it did not perform. Paired with a resumable worker that recovers tasks stranded by function timeouts, and a cron heartbeat that lets seats pull from and push results to a shared task board.

Direction Invariants ORG CHART AS TYPES

Only a packaged conclusion or a flagged terminal notice may travel upward through the tree; a question moving up is rejected by the transport itself. Escalation policy is compiled into the message type system instead of being requested in a prompt. Every failure mode — hops exceeded, direction violation, contract violation, unregistered target — emits a distinct terminal notice back to origin with its own counter.

The Triad Pattern ANTI-GROUPTHINK

Two specialist lenses — one quantitative, one interpretive — deliberately non-overlapping and structurally sealed from one another so they cannot converge socially. A single pacemaker reconciles them, maps their agreement to a confidence figure, applies a release gate, and is the only voice out. Any lens reading unfavorable holds a veto, and a domain-specific honesty cap prevents a confident recommendation on modeled data.

Programmatic Provisioning TEXT TO BUSINESS

A build pipeline that creates a repository, creates a hosting project and starts a fresh branded product end to end against the GitHub and Vercel APIs, driven from a visual front end where a vertical is chosen, branded and generated. SaaS tenant provisioning, operated by one person.

Safety Enforced by Absence LEARNER PRODUCTS

Guarantees implemented as missing capability rather than instruction. There is no timer code, so a child cannot be raced; no error-red token, so failure cannot be rendered; no schema field where agent-authored prose could ride, plus an n-gram fence rejecting content words the child did not write. A rule expressible as configuration is one write from repeal; a rule that is structurally unrepresentable is not.

Skins Engine ACCESSIBILITY GUARD

Per-user themes selected at sign-in and applied without flash on page transition, with a runtime contrast auto-fixer that computes contrast ratios and forces readable text on any light-on-light control — touching only broken pairs and never intentional color.

Native Realtime Communication OWN WEBRTC

Video conferencing built on own signaling rather than a third-party SDK — one-to-one and group video, persistent channels, translated messaging, asynchronous video, and guest links joinable from a plain browser with no account and no per-seat license.

Self-Hosted Mail & Groupware LINUX · \$0/MONTH

Provisioned an Ubuntu server on free-tier cloud infrastructure and stood up a complete mail system: Postfix receiving on 25, Dovecot IMAP over TLS on 993, authenticated submission on 587, and Radicale CalDAV/CardDAV on 5232, fronted by a Let's Encrypt certificate with automatic renewal. **SPF, DKIM at 2048 bits, and DMARC all published and passing.** Cut the MX record over from Google Workspace, retiring the subscription — five mailboxes plus catch-all forwarding across two domains, with legacy addresses preserved indefinitely. Worked around the provider's blanket outbound port-25 block with an authenticated SMTP relay, and added two gigabytes of swap to keep the services stable on a 954 MB instance. The console provisioning form proved unusable, so the whole box was built through the cloud CLI. Delivery confirmed in the mail log rather than assumed.

Engineering Governance 16 ARTICLES

A written constitution covering approval gates, credential fences, honesty rules ("*blank beats confident-wrong*"; every figure tagged live-data, estimate or assumption), a live-verification mandate that treats reporting a stale claim as fabrication, and a session-package rule requiring architecture, code, brief and handoff for every unit of work.

Design is not a layer applied at the end here; it is the third step and it sets the scheme. On every product the sequence is name, mark, icon — and only then code. The icon decides the palette, the weight, the personality and the vocabulary the software inherits, so making it early is a design decision about the whole system rather than a cosmetic one made late.

Naming the line. I named all fourteen vertical products — Abode, Buttress, Truss, Musical, 8mm, Amphitheater, LilNinja, 4barrel, Targeted, Stay@Home, Smiley, Sleeves, Toolbelt and Moments — along with the consumer families and their individual apps. When an earlier generation of names stopped fitting, I retired every one of them at once rather than letting two vocabularies coexist. **The retirement is enforced rather than remembered:** the canonical names live in a single source file, the rule that retired names never reappear is written into the engineering constitution, and a surviving instance of an old name is treated as a defect to fix, not a variant to tolerate. That is what keeps a brand consistent across fourteen pricing pages, fourteen showrooms and a storefront.

The identity. A single warm system — espresso to forest on a 120° gradient, gold for emphasis, cream for light surfaces, with a faint gold grid — replacing an earlier blue identity that was retired wholesale and archived rather than left to drift. One mark kit is the source for every surface; the correct variant for each background is specified rather than chosen by eye each time.

Icons as a build artifact. Each product's mark is authored as a master SVG by hand — no drawing tool — and compiled by a Python pipeline into a complete store kit: **thirteen iOS sizes, Android adaptive foreground and background at every density with the 66% safe zone respected, the Play 512**, and rendered QA proofs so the output is inspected rather than assumed. Roughly fifty files per product, reproducible from one source. The house style for app marks is deliberately flat and repeatable — dark tile, light inner panel, one bold stroke symbol, one accent dot, no gradients or shadows — so a new product looks like a member of the family on the day it ships. The kit is treated as mandatory, not optional: **a missing apple-touch-icon causes iOS to screenshot the page and use that as the icon**, which is a brand failure produced by an omission rather than a decision.

Design system and theming. Brand tokens rather than hardcoded values, documented components, and a portable theming engine that lets an entire hub be reskinned per tenant without forking the interface — the same mechanism that makes a white-label product viable. Every surface is judged phone-first at 402 pixels before anything else, because that is where these are actually used.

Motion built on physics. No linear easing anywhere; spring and ease-out curves, velocity-based fling on swipe, a haptic tick on commitment, correct overscroll behaviour, and **prefers-reduced-motion** honoured throughout. Motion is specified as a standard rather than improvised per screen, so interactions feel like one instrument rather than fourteen.

Accessibility, measured rather than claimed. The palette is audited against WCAG 2.1 AA contrast ratios rather than eyeballed, with results precomputed for the current brand colours. **The audit currently records a known failure** — one muted foreground token against the forest background — which is carried as an open finding instead of being quietly rounded up to compliant. Same rule as everywhere else in this record: the measurement is only useful if it is allowed to say no.

Illustration and character work. Mascots, characters and app illustration drawn as clean SVG, including work rebuilt from reference into production art. The working method is render-then-look — output the drawing, examine it, and correct it — because a character that reads as the wrong animal or lands in the uncanny middle cannot be diagnosed from the code alone.

Design decisions with commercial consequences. Replacing the sales deck with the product itself — every vertical opens as a live showroom running the real software on realistic data in the prospect's own browser — was a design call before it was a sales one. So was the choice to state limits inside the interface rather than in a footnote, and to build products that decline to display a value they cannot stand behind.

03 PRODUCTS SHIPPED — BUSINESS PLATFORM

Fourteen multi-tenant white-label operating systems, each live and enterable as a gated showroom running the real software on seeded data. Monthly list prices \$99–\$650.

PRODUCT	VERTICAL	DOMAIN MODELED
Abode OS	Real estate	Listings, deal spine, transaction coordination
Buttress OS	Architecture	Drawings, phases, submittals, the books that compute off the same record
Truss OS	Engineering	Pursuits and go/no-go, WBS, field RFIs, calcs and standards, PE-seal gate, permits and AHJ, multipliers — with a discipline module switch for civil, mechanical and software
Smiley OS	Dental practices	Chair time, treatment plans, the practice money engine
Stay@Home OS	Home care agencies	Caregiver scheduling, visit records, care plans
Toolbelt OS	HVAC, plumbing, electrical	Dispatch switchboard, web booking, trucks and jobs
4barrel OS	Used-car dealers	Inventory, reconditioning, desking
Musical OS	Live theater	Box office, seat authority, production spine, program
8mm OS	Film & production	Slate, crew, schedule, settlement
Amphitheater OS	Concerts & venues	Holds and confirms, settlement, day-of-show
Moments OS	Photo & video	Sessions, galleries, delivery, a solo-class price floor
Sleeves OS	Tattoo studios	Artists, deposits, booking, consent
Targeted OS	Marketing agencies	Campaigns, audiences, creative rounds, reporting
LilNinja OS	Kids gyms & programs	Memberships, sessions, waivers, family accounts

04 PRODUCTS SHIPPED — CONSUMER

Thirty-four applications across nine shelves, most free to try, all live.

Music & making	ESPO Music — five instrument coaches (guitar, piano, harmonica, ukulele, bass) from one shared engine with Karplus–Strong synthesis. ESPO Fret, the guitar coach — built because I wanted to learn to play; now a shipping product with subscription billing · ESPOfunkmaster, a browser studio with drums, keys, looper, mic, mixer and record cutting · ESPO Cutlabs, a video editor · AE Cre8, eight machines that make things
Learning	ESPO Learning (handwriting, reading, math, composition — no fail states, COPPA-clean) · ESPOhystory · ESPOvocab · ESPOwords · ESPOdraw
Mind & mood	Neuro Divulge regulation tools · The Thread · ESPOtendency · ESPOregulator · ESPOfocus
Money & fine print	ESPO Genius (plain-English paperwork) · The Narcs — The Narc and MarketNarc, a fundamentals-and-technicals analysis triad · ESPOsign
Journals	ESPOvineyard · ESPOstogie · ESPOwhiskey · ESPObarista — on-device, no ads, no marketplace
Travel & sport	ESPOtrek · ESPOnatlparks (offline passport, 63 parks) · ESPOracket
Family & other	ESPOnest · ESPO Drama · Revolver OS · Sparkle Salon

Functional-medicine telehealth practice — premium build

2026

Installable progressive web app with a native tab bar; native WebRTC video visits; translated patient messaging; asynchronous video check-ins between appointments; AI-assisted clinical note drafting; a talking in-app assistant with voice out and speech in; separate staff and patient themes; and a written access model covering data ownership, least-privilege roles, logged administrative entry, an accounting fence, and a revocation path that cuts the vendor's access without touching anything the client owns.

Regional nonprofit theater — full operating system, pro bono

2026

In-house ticketing with server-authoritative seat holds replacing a third-party dependency; box office and point of sale; CRM with cross-domain person joins uniting roles, crews and classes on one record; patron lifetime-value history; nonprofit books to 990 standard with an audit-safe void path; role-aware navigation across eleven staff and volunteer roles; records management; a show library and scene shop; a program builder; marketing and newsletter tooling; and an in-hub AI creative director. A companion advisory triad monitors box-office health on a clear / watch / intervene scale.

Engineering firm · youth sports organization — vertical builds

2026

Phase-native project spines from pursuit through invoice, field logs, permitting workflow, books with utilization multipliers, and departmental agent routing.

06 AEPSYCHOGRAPH — HOUSEHOLD SEGMENTATION ENGINE

The premise. Rebuild PRIZM-class household segmentation on free public government data, minus the license layer. Commercial comparables list between \$1,645 per year and \$1,500 per month.

The model. Forty-eight segments across four urbanization tiers, four affluence tiers and three lifestages; fourteen activities; eight psychographic types; indices computed as a segment's rate over the national average, times one hundred, clamped to a 20–320 band.

The sources. US Census American Community Survey five-year tables for income, households with own children, and 65-and-over; Bureau of Economic Analysis state personal consumption; Bureau of Labor Statistics Consumer Expenditure series, cached and refreshed on a thirty-day cycle.

The honesty constraint, enforced in code. Who a household is comes from real Census data; what they are likely to do is modeled — and the two are never allowed to blur. Without live Census data the pacemaker is hard-capped below the targeting threshold, making a confident targeting recommendation on modeled data **arithmetically impossible rather than merely discouraged**. Classifiers are required to return "unclassified" and "unassessable" rather than force a label.

What it is. A monitoring platform that answers two questions for the same owner: *is my infrastructure working?* and *can I prove it was?* It runs credential-free checks against a business's public infrastructure on a schedule, rolls them up to a plain-language state, hands back the exact remediation, and seals every run into tamper-evident, dated evidence. Research, architecture, engine, front end, deployment and live verification of the first working version were completed in a single day; it was extended over the following day into the shipped product described here.

The engine — nine controls, zero credentials, zero dependencies. A Node serverless function evaluates, per domain: **SPF** (only authorized servers can send as the domain), **DMARC** (spoofed mail is reported and can be rejected), **MX** (mail routing resolves), **MTA-STS** (mail transport encryption is enforced, verified by fetching the policy file — the DNS record alone does nothing), **TLS-RPT** (transport failures are reported), **TLS** (certificate valid, protocol current, expiry counted in days), **DNSSEC** (the delegation is signed), **CAA** (only named authorities may issue certificates), and **browser security headers** (CSP, HSTS, nosniff, frame-options, referrer-policy). Every check is free and public. No customer credential is ever requested, held, or required.

Authoritative resolution, and why it exists. The engine does not trust a recursive resolver. For every domain it looks up the registered domain's own nameservers and queries those directly, labeling each result with its `dns_source`. This exists because the first build used a recursive resolver, received an empty TXT answer, and produced a **false "no SPF record" finding** against a domain that did have SPF. A recursive answer is hearsay; evidence comes from the authority. The bug was caught by checking output against a second source, the resolver was rewritten, and **the incorrect evidence pack was formally marked void rather than quietly edited**.

Three further classes of false failure, each found and eliminated. A compliance tool that reports a failure that isn't real is worse than no tool at all, so the applicability model became the product's central design problem rather than an edge case.

— **Category errors.** Application hosts such as `*.vercel.app` have no mail service and cannot send or receive; scoring them "no SPF, no DMARC, no MX" produced three red failures per client property for controls that do not exist there. Host-type detection now returns **N/A**, and the score reads passed-over-applicable rather than passed-over-total.

— **Unanswerable queries.** Node has no `resolveDs`, and `DNSKEY` is not a supported record type, so the first DNSSEC and CAA implementation reported "not signed" and "no CAA" for **every domain tested, including Cloudflare's own** — which is demonstrably signed and does publish CAA. Caught by testing against a known-good third party rather than only against my own estate. Both checks were moved to DNS-over-HTTPS against two independent resolvers, and an unanswerable query now returns **UNKNOWN, never FAIL**. Scoring "we could not check it" as a red X is fabrication by omission.

— **Healthy things that look broken.** An authenticated endpoint answering `401` is a working endpoint. Only a dead socket, a timeout or a `5xx` is an outage. Scoring an auth gate as down would page a human on every single run.

The evidence vault — server-side by necessity. Each result is serialized deterministically and hashed with SHA-256 together with the previous entry's hash, forming an append-only chain in which any retroactive alteration invalidates every hash after it. Provable ordering and tamper-evidence without a paid notary or timestamping service. **The chain is computed on the server, never in the browser** — evidence a client calculates for itself is not evidence, because anything a client computes it can also fabricate. Storage degrades honestly: when the store is unreachable the response reports `stored:false` with a reason rather than presenting an unsaved run as sealed.

Framework packs, with the limits attached to the findings. Results can be read against HIPAA, home-care and insurance-audit mappings. Every pack carries a mandatory `covers and doesNotCover` statement that travels in the same payload as the findings, so the limits are structurally inseparable from the results. The HIPAA pack states in its own output that it does not address §164.308 administrative or §164.310 physical safeguards and **is not a HIPAA risk assessment**. A limitation in a footer can be screenshotted away; one inside the payload cannot.

Tenant isolation, and an honest account of its ceiling. Each customer holds a random twenty-four-character workspace key that scopes their evidence chain, history and watchlist — no account, no password, no personal data collected. Isolation was **verified live rather than assumed**: a second workspace was created and confirmed to see an empty genesis chain while the first held its own tip and history. The limit is stated plainly in the product's own privacy page: the object store on this account **rejects private access outright**, so stored objects are technically readable by anyone holding the URL. What protects a customer is that the URL contains their unguessable key — **a capability, which is real protection, but is not an access-control list**, and no page is permitted to describe it as one. Records hold domain names and check results only; real ACLs are a precondition of ever holding anything more sensitive.

Scheduled monitoring that actually monitors. The daily job walks every registered workspace watchlist, re-runs that customer's domains against their chosen framework, and seals the results into *their* chain. This is called out because the first version of the schedule checked only three hardcoded internal domains while the interface said "around-the-clock monitoring" — a promise the product did not keep. **The gap was found by auditing my own marketing copy against my own cron job**, and the interface was additionally corrected to say plainly that email alerting is not switched on yet, rather than implying a notification path that does not exist.

Observe-only, permanently — a business decision expressed as an architecture. The companion IT · System Health capability monitors service reachability, certificate expiry thresholded in days rather than booleans, and integration key status as booleans only, with key *values* never read or returned. It rolls up to **CLEAR / WATCH / INTERVENE** and produces a fix list where every entry carries what it means, what to do, and — where a literal value exists — the exact string to paste. It does not, and will not, remediate anything itself. Errors-and-omissions and cyber liability coverage was priced at roughly \$245 per month and **declined**; the resulting rule is that Accelerated Experiences LLC does not take the keys to machines it does not already run. That boundary is written into the specification as a permanent product definition rather than a limitation to be engineered around later.

Validated against its own maker before being offered to anyone. Run across the full ten-domain company estate. It found real defects; every one was remediated and re-verified at the authoritative nameservers, taking DMARC coverage from three of ten domains to ten of ten and closing the estate with zero open findings. **Two findings were deliberately left unremediated and documented as such** — a monitor-only DMARC policy that should not be tightened before report data has been read, and a Content-Security-Policy whose incorrect deployment breaks a working storefront and requires a report-only observation period first. That policy was instead shipped in report-only mode with a collector endpoint written to read the raw request stream, because the platform does not body-parse the `application/csp-report` content type and the first version silently logged empty reports while appearing healthy. **Knowing which findings not to fix immediately, and detecting a monitor that is quietly recording nothing, is the difference between a compliance tool and a liability.**

Governance tooling built alongside it. The engineering constitution that governs this and every other system was given a self-verifying stamp and an automated consistency gate: a checker recomputes the document's hash, verifies article sequence, and compares the two independent copies. It caught a one-character divergence between them that every structural check had passed. The gate deliberately treats an *unstamped* document as a failure rather than a pass — an unverifiable constitution cannot be trusted, and the first version of my own gate had that backwards.

Two products killed on purpose. Compliance monitoring and IT health were built independently, in parallel, and found to overlap by roughly seventy percent while selling to the same captive audience. Rather than ship both, they were merged into one engine and one interface. The merged capability was then briefly specified as a paid fourth pricing tier across fourteen products — and that tier was **cancelled before it shipped** in favor of including it with each product's existing top plan, removing a pricing change across fourteen pages and eliminating an outlier where the flat uplift would have raised one product's price by ninety-one percent. The commercial argument became *free tells you, paid proves it*: operational health is visible to everyone because it costs nothing to run, and the sealed evidence is what the top tier contains.

Cost of goods: \$0 recurring. DNS, TLS handshakes, HTTP response headers, DNS-over-HTTPS, and public control catalogs. Paid feeds were **excluded rather than faked**, and the interface declines to display any control it cannot honestly evaluate. The deployment ships with the exact security headers the product tells clients to add, so it passes its own audit.

Stated limits. External, credential-free checks only; authenticated posture integrations are specified and not built. Email alerting is not switched on. It is a readiness and evidence tool, **not a certification body** — it cannot issue an attestation, and neither can any competitor, since that requires a licensed CPA firm, but the distinction is stated in the product's own interface rather than buried. Incumbents in the adjacent category (Vanta, Drata, Secureframe, Sprinto) run \$6,000–\$28,000 per year and sell to venture-backed startups pursuing SOC 2; this sells to businesses facing county inspectors, insurance audits and HIPAA — dental, home care, telehealth, trades, engineering — where those incumbents do not compete and the deliverable is an organized binder rather than an auditor portal. It has **no paying customers as of this writing**: live, functional, validated and included in the product line, but not yet sold.

The defect found after launch, and why it matters. The room is served both at its own domain and, through a rewrite, under a path on the company store. The front end used absolute `/api/` paths, which at the mounted location resolve to the *store* root — where only one of its three endpoints was mapped. The evidence vault returned 404, **no tenant workspace was ever created, and every run came back unsealed while the interface reported "sealed in the vault."** All nine checks rendered correctly the entire time, which is precisely why it survived a full day of testing: every prior verification had used the direct domain, where absolute paths resolve correctly. **The sealed evidence is the entire commercial reason the top tier exists; at the public address, that half had never happened once.** Fixed by resolving API calls against the page's own directory — required in any case for the product to run mounted inside a host application. **My own first fix was wrong and was reverted rather than reconciled:** it populated the displayed key from a second source that disagreed with the one the evidence sealed under, replacing an empty field with a confidently incorrect value. Of the two, showing the wrong answer is the worse failure, and it is the same error the engine's applicability model exists to prevent.

The record-keeping standard written off the back of it. Codified as a constitutional article: every project is logged in the company's own operating system at the start; scheduling is deliberately *not* required, because work here completes within a day across several parallel AI instances and dates would be noise — the requirement is the log, not the calendar. The log must state what was done and **who did it**, name every document produced, and close with a written brief covering what was built, what was decided and by whom, what broke, what remains open and what it cost. **If a defect is found after the brief is filed, an addendum is filed against it rather than the original being quietly corrected** — the same instinct as the hash chain: a record is only worth something if it cannot be rewritten to look better. The constitution itself carries a self-verifying checksum, and an automated gate confirms its three independent copies match.

What it is. A fraud-protection suite for community banks and credit unions, built August 2026 and launching the same month. Three rooms with one job: **SCREEN** checks names against the live U.S. Treasury OFAC SDN and Consolidated lists; **WATCH** triages a transaction file against the classic fraud and laundering typologies; **FILE** promotes any alert into a case with its evidence chain and a SAR-style draft narrative, exported as a packet for the institution's own review. The incumbents (NICE Actimize, Verafin, Unit21, Featurespace) sell custom-quoted suites at \$2,000–\$15,000 per month behind 60–90-day core-system integrations; this takes the no-integration path — the bank drags a file into a browser — at a published flat price, never per-seat.

Every alert shows its work. SCREEN hits carry a match score, the matching route (name or listed alias), the exact list entry, and a link to verify that entry on the Treasury's own sanctions search. WATCH alerts cite the exact rows that triggered them — structuring kept under the \$10,000 currency-reporting threshold inside a 7-day window, velocity spikes measured against the party's own median active day, round-dollar repeats, exact-amount duplicates within 3 days, dormant relationships waking up with a large movement, and new payees arriving straight into the file's 95th-percentile amounts. The release gate is written into the product: **no citation, no alert.**

The privacy architecture is the pitch. WATCH runs entirely in the bank's own browser — the transaction file is parsed (CSV or NACHA/ACH entry-detail records) and scored client-side and never transmitted or stored. The only data that leaves the machine is a name the user explicitly sends to the sanctions screen. For a two-person compliance shop, the security review answers itself.

Stated limits, in the product's own interface. A CLEAR is a screening result at a stated threshold, not a background check or legal determination; a HIT is a lead for a human, not an accusation. Case narratives are drafts — the institution's BSA officer reviews, decides and files. The typology engine catches the classic patterns and says so plainly rather than claiming behavioral learning it does not yet perform. When a sanctions list cannot be loaded, the product says which list and screens against the rest — it does not pretend. **No paying customers as of this writing:** built, launching, and priced — not yet sold.

THE THROUGH-LINE — INSIDE THE SYSTEM CHANGE, FIVE TIMES

I have had to learn a new operating system at every job I have held. At **four of them the company actually replaced the software that ran the business while I was sitting in it** — and I was on the pilot side every time. Five changes, four companies, three industries, all of it before I wrote a line of code.

The Press Democrat (New York Times Media Group) — the paper replaced its legacy publishing system with **PBS**. PBS had no module for my department, so I **built the database-marketing system myself in FileMaker** and ran the direct mail on it. The new platform did not serve the vertical, so I built the vertical. 2003 — 2007

Avalon Care Center, Community Relations Director — piloted the **CRM for the corporate company**. 2012 — 2015

Harvard Park Retirement Center (Holiday Retirement) — a **brand-new operating system** came in across the company while I was General Manager, carrying the P&L. 2016 — 2019

A Place for Mom — on the **pilot team for the chat channel**, a role the company created by moving me off phones. 2019 — 2020

A Place for Mom — piloted **Beacon, the operating system the company runs on**, while it was still being built: live, against real families, feeding defects back to the builders. 2023 — 2024

You cannot survive a system change without mapping the process first. That is where the process-mapping comes from — not a technique I studied, but the thing four of these jobs made me do to keep working. It is also the reason the fourteen operating systems in section 03 are shaped the way they are: every one of them is a vertical the big platform did not serve.

Digital & Creative Engineer/Founder — Accelerated Experiences LLC · Post Falls, ID MAY 2026 — PRESENT

Accelerated Experiences LLC formed May 2026.

- Sole architect, engineer, designer and operator of everything catalogued in sections 01 through 05.
- Owned the commercial side end to end: pricing architecture across the fleet, a single authoritative price record with per-product locks, packaging and tiering, and a deliberate no-per-seat-pricing promise enforced as a product constraint.
- **Recruited and equipped two commission sales representatives** across six states with territory playbooks, objection handling and a 372-record qualified lead database.
- Built the media production stack that markets the work: procedural video render pipelines, a voice engine, and a browser video editor — used to produce product films for every vertical.

Homeschool Educator — North Idaho 2024 — 2026

Homeschooled four children, grades K–6, designing curriculum and building the educational tools that became the ESPO Learning product line — and the direct source of the no-fail-states-by-architecture safety rule.

Online/Chat Senior Living Advisor — A Place for Mom · fully remote

2019 — 2024

Advised families through the senior-living decision in writing rather than by phone — intake, triage, needs assessment and placement, live, in text. **The role did not exist before I took it:** the company moved me off phones to stand the chat channel up.

- **Chat team pilot, 2019–2020.** On the pilot team for the channel itself — working out how a conversation that had always been a phone call actually gets done in text: how you triage in writing, what a written handoff has to carry so the next person can act on it, and where the channel broke.
- **Beacon pilot, 2023–2024.** Beacon is the operating system A Place for Mom runs on. I piloted the CRM inside it while it was still being built — running it live against real families and feeding the defects back to the people building it.
- Two system changes from the inside of the same job: the channel, then the platform underneath it. **The second and third of three CRM builds I have piloted in production.**

General Manager — Harvard Park Retirement Center (Holiday Retirement)

2016 — 2019

Marketing Director & Community Education — senior care providers, Inland Northwest

2010 — 2016

Fourteen years of P&L ownership, census and referral-network growth, community education programming, and compliance-bounded operations across the continuum of senior care. See **The through-line** at the head of this section.

Marketing Analyst — Bay Area News Group, I-80 Network · Vallejo, CA

2008 — 2010

Launched an analytics department spanning three daily newspapers — the Vallejo *Times-Herald*, the Woodland *Daily Democrat* and the Vacaville *Reporter* — including requirements, data model, custom system build and rollout across all three properties.

Market Researcher & Database Marketer — Sales Farm · Petaluma, CA

2007 — 2008

Market research and PRIZM segmentation analysis for a startup agency's client roster.

Marketing Analyst — The Press Democrat, New York Times Media Group · Santa Rosa, CA

2003 — 2007

- Promoted from temp staffer to Marketing Analyst in two years; **built the company's direct-mail system** from the data model up.
- **The paper replaced its legacy publishing system with PBS — and PBS had no module for my department.** I built the database-marketing system myself in **FileMaker** and ran the direct mail on it. The new platform did not serve the vertical, so I built the vertical. That is the shape of the whole company described in section 03, arrived at twenty years early.
- Led analytics across the daily and its sister publications — *Savor*, *Wine Country*, the Petaluma and Santa Rosa magazines, and the associated web properties.
- Applied **household-level PRIZM / Claritas segmentation** to editorial, circulation and advertiser targeting; supported major retail accounts including Macy's, Gottschalks and Lowe's.
- **Ran print production on a physical board** — a card for every job moving through designer, printer, mailhouse, list procurement, drop date and in-home date — and built an early estimating, production and accounting system so the gross margin set at the estimate was the figure the books were held to. **That is the spine model described in section 01, arrived at two decades before I could express it in software.**

Administrative Assistant to the HR Director — City of Santa Rosa, CA · summer position during college

SUMMER

The Founder Triad: How One Human and Two Instances of the Same AI Built a Production System

JUN 2026

A thesis on the working method behind the platform. Argues that a single operator holding the pacemaker seat between a design instance and a build instance can stand up a product family with production discipline, provided shared knowledge lives in documents rather than memory, safety promises are enforced by architecture rather than instruction, and one seat is never delegated. States precisely which seat that is and why: the errors that mattered were errors *inside the canon* — the one place referees and tests cannot look. Closes with a section titled **Honest Limits** enumerating everything the system had not yet earned the right to claim.

The AETriad Training Playbook v1.0

JUN 2026

The reusable method for building and tuning an agent triad, framed around five levers — Role, Knowledge, Tools, Output Contract, Feedback Loop — with the claim that only the fifth constitutes real learning, and a fully worked expert-review → diagnose → patch → route-evidence → verify episode as the reference case.

The AE Constitution

2026, LIVING

Sixteen articles of engineering governance: authority and approval gates, credential fences, truth and honesty rules with a formal output contract, live-verification mandates, a quality bar, brand law, delivery and session-package requirements, shipping cadence, memory and continuity, and learner safety.

11 TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

LANGUAGES	Python 3 · Node.js (ESM) · JavaScript · HTML · CSS · SVG
AI & AGENTS	Anthropic Claude · DeepSeek · ElevenLabs · prompt and role architecture · evaluation harnesses and golden-data referees · adversarial red-team corpora · confidence gating and derived-conviction models · tool-use and output-contract design · multi-agent orchestration and routing · retrieval over canonical documents
PLATFORM	Vercel serverless functions, multi-project tenant isolation, cron scheduling, redirects · GitHub · key-value and blob storage · environment-gated graceful degradation · single sign-on and role-based access control
INFRASTRUCTURE	Ubuntu 24.04 on Oracle Cloud · CLI-based instance provisioning · Postfix · Dovecot · Radicale · Let's Encrypt and TLS certificate automation · SPF, DKIM and DMARC · DNS, MX and zone administration · SSH key management · swap and resource tuning on constrained hosts
REALTIME	WebRTC with own signaling · Web Speech API · progressive web apps and service workers · offline-first storage
DATA	US Census ACS · BLS Consumer Expenditure · BEA SAPCE · FRED · segmentation and index modeling · PRIZM / Claritas methodology · FileMaker
MEDIA	Python with PIL and NumPy for procedural rendering · FFmpeg and FFprobe · CairoSVG · ReportLab · WeasyPrint · voice cloning and audio-video muxing · on-device OCR · Karplus–Strong synthesis
COMMERCE	Stripe · Google Play publishing · Google Search Console, sitemaps and technical SEO · pricing and packaging architecture
VERIFICATION	Python conformance suites · property-based tests · browser suites · syntax gates on every deployed module · live-URL verification as a release requirement

University of Idaho — B.S. Media Communications, Advertising & Public Relations	1999 — 2003
Chairman's Award — The Press Democrat, New York Times Media Group	—
Presenter, Claritas national conference — San Diego, CA	—
Mentored by Bill Truett in household segmentation methodology	—